

CURRICULUM VITAE

Ya-Wen (Yama) Chang, M.A.

yama.chang.gr@dartmouth.edu | [Personal Website](#) | [GitHub](#)

EDUCATION

- 2024 – **Geisel School of Medicine, Dartmouth College** Hanover, NH
 Ph.D. student in Quantitative Biomedical Science & Center for Technology and Behavioral Health
 Advisor: Nicholas Jacobson (AI and Mental Health: Innovation in Technology-Guided Healthcare Laboratory)
 Coursework: Machine Learning; Algorithms; AI for Wearable Neurotech; Applied Biostatistics;
 Analysis of Densely Collected Longitudinal Data; Bioinformatics
- 2018 – 2020 **Teachers College, Columbia University** New York, NY
M.A. in Clinical Psychology, Concentration in Quantitative Methods, GPA: 4.0/4.0
- 2008 – 2012 **National Taiwan University** Taipei, Taiwan
B.A. in Economics

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[Google Scholar Profile](#) * indicates equal contribution

1. Sotomayor, I., **Chang, Y.**, Szkody, E., Fox, K., Schleider J. (2026). A Digital, Minority Stress-Focused Single-Session Intervention Benefits Multiply-Minoritized Sexual Minority Adolescents. *Journal of Clinical Child & Adolescent Psychology*. [[Web](#)] [[Preprint](#)]
2. **Chang, Y.**, Sotomayor, I., Szkody, E., Fox, K., Schleider J. (2025). Effectiveness of an Online Single-Session Minority Stress Intervention: No Evidence for Variation by Structural Stigma, Internalized Stigma, or Social Support. *SSM-Mental Health*, 100409. [[Web](#)] [[Preprint](#)] [[Pre-registration](#)]
3. Brown, V., Gujral, S., **Chang, Y.**, Galfalvy, H., Szanto, K., & Dombrovski, A.Y. (2025). Brain volume reductions and relationship with depression and cognitive functioning in suicide in older adults: A cross-sectional and longitudinal study using Bayesian multilevel modeling. *Biological Psychiatry: Global Open Science*.
4. Paine, E., Abad, M., Barucco, R., **Chang, Y.**, Navalta, T., Vance, T., Ehrhardt, A., Bockting, W. (2025). “Too Much Trouble”: Transgender and Nonbinary People’s Experiences of Stigmatization and Stigma Avoidance in the Workplace. *Work and Occupations*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/07308884241268705>
5. **Chang, Y.***, Schumacher, E.*, Martino, R., Maheux, A., Choukas-Bradley, S., Salk, R., & Thoma, B. (2024). Structural Homophobia and Suicidal Ideation and Behavior Among Sexual and Gender Minority Adolescents. *Stigma and Health*. <https://doi.org/10.1037/sah0000576>
6. Szkody, E., **Chang, Y.**, Schleider, J. L. (2023). Serving the Underserved? Uptake, Effectiveness, and Acceptability of Digital SSIs for Rural American Adolescents. *Journal of Clinical Child and Adolescent Psychology*. [[Web](#)] [[Preprint](#)] [[Pre-registration](#)] [[Code](#)]
7. **Chang, Y.**, Buerke, M., Galfalvy, H., & Szanto, K. (2023). Childhood Trauma is Associated with Early-Onset but not Late-Onset Suicidal Behavior in Late-Life Depression. *International Psychogeriatrics*, 1-14. PMID: 37642013 [[Web](#)]
8. Galfalvy, H., Szücs, A., **Chang, Y.**, Buerke, M., & Szanto, K. (2023). Long-Term Suicidal Ideation Profiles in Late-Life Depression and Their Association with Suicide Attempt or Death by Suicide. *The Journal of Clinical Psychiatry*, 84(2), 22m14469. PMID: 36791367 [[Web](#)]

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

1. Szkody, E., Hobaica, S., Jans, L., Bergstrom, T., **Chang, Y.**, Smith, A. C., & Schleider, J. L. (R&R). Structural Stigma and LGBTQ+ Youth Mental Health. [[Preprint](#)]

SELECTED MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

1. **Chang, Y.**, Han, H. J., Griffin, T. Z., Marsch L., Heinz, M. V., Campbell, A. T., Jacobson, N. C. (In Preparation). Reliability of an autonomous LLM agent for delivering evidence-based behavioral interventions from passive sensing.
2. **Chang, Y.**, Heinz, M. V., Griffin, T. Z., Nemesure, M. D., Lekkas, D., Pillai, A., Collins, A. C., Nepal, S., Daniel, M., Price, G. D., Campbell, A. T., Jacobson, N. C. (In Preparation). The Digital Balance: A Multilevel Vector Autoregressive Analysis of Online and In-Person Social Behavior in Major Depressive Disorder.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

2024 – Present **AI and Mental Health: Innovation in Technology-Guided Healthcare Laboratory, Dartmouth College**
Principal Investigator: Nicholas Jacobson, Ph.D.
Research Area: AI and mental health, large language models, passive sensing and wearables

PhD Researcher

- Lead research on Evergreen, a generative AI system for just-in-time adaptive mental wellbeing interventions using passive sensing and conversational AI
- Design context-aware decision engines that infer intervention timing from multimodal behavioral signals, including mobility, sleep, stress, and screen activity
- Develop LLM-based and multi-agent pipelines for state detection, intervention selection, and safe tool-augmented delivery in real-world settings
- Collaborate across psychology, engineering, and design to integrate sensing, evidence-based interventions, and AI reasoning into scalable mental health support systems
- Prepare research manuscripts on AI decision systems, adaptive intervention timing, and multimodal sensing for digital mental health

2022 – 2024 **Lab for Scalable Mental Health, Northwestern University**
Principal Investigator: Jessica Schleider, Ph.D.
Research Area: Digital mental health interventions, minority mental health, machine learning

Data Scientist

- Performed data visualization and advanced analysis using R and Python (e.g., machine learning, time-series modeling, hierarchical linear modeling, confirmatory factor analysis, and mediation/moderation analysis)
- Cleaned and de-identified large-scale datasets (e.g., EMA data, longitudinal datasets) to create analytical base tables and contributed to open data repositories (e.g., GitHub and OSF)
- Developed and visualized a county-level index in the U.S. using large-scale open datasets (600,000+ records) to study structural stigma towards LGBTQ+
- Promoted open data management, promoting transparency, reproducibility, and data integrity
- Served as a statistical consultant to doctoral students and research coordinators, providing expertise on data analysis and coding using the R programming language

2020 – 2022 **Department of Psychiatry, University of Pittsburgh School of Medicine**
Principal Investigator: Katalin Szanto, M.D.
Research Area: Late-life suicide and late-life depression

Senior Research/Data Analyst

- Led independent research projects, including conceptualizing research questions into hypotheses, developing and applying analytic strategies, writing first authorship manuscripts, and present research findings at national and international conferences
- Built statistical models using R for classification and prediction, communicate results to investigators using informative graphics, and write co-authorship manuscripts
- Generated and present data-driven reports using R Markdown to better inform recruitment practices for case-control study, reducing the gender gap to only 8%
- Cleaned and prepared open datasets for sharing to NIMH Data Archive

2018 – 2020

Program for the Study of LGBT Health
Department of Psychiatry, Columbia University Irving Medical Center
Principal Investigator: Walter Bockting, Ph.D.
Research Area: LGBTQ+ mental health, minority stress model

Research Intern

- Led an independent research project from conceptual framework development to quantitative data analysis, data visualization, and first-authoring our manuscript
- Transcribed 26 interview scripts and used Dedoose software for qualitative coding and thematic content analysis

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Conference Presentations

1. **Chang, Y.**, Han, H. J., Ross, M. K., & Seo, H., & Kaveladze, B. (2025, December). *Building an intelligent mental health app: Integrating passive sensing, prediction, and conversational AI interventions*. [Symposium presentation]. 9th Annual Technology in Psychiatry Summit (TiPS), Virtual.
2. **Chang, Y.**, Sotomayor, I., Szkody, E., Fox, K., & Schleider, J. L. (2023, November). Effectiveness of an Online Single-Session Minority Stress Intervention: Variation by Structural Stigma? In Ahuvia, I., & McKetta, S. (Chairs), Price, M. (Discussant), *The Role of Structural Stigma in Psychopathology Among Marginalized Youth*. [Symposium presentation]. 57th annual meeting of the Association of Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies, Seattle, WA.
3. Sotomayor, I., **Chang, Y.**, Szkody, E., Fox, K., & Schleider, J. L. (2023, November). Intersectionality and a minority stress-based single-session intervention benefit multiply-marginalized LGBTQ+ adolescents. In A.L. Silverman & G. Ramos (Co-Chairs), A. Aguilera (Discussant), *Leveraging digital mental health interventions to increase access to care among marginalized racial and ethnic groups*. Symposium to be presented at the 57th annual meeting of the Association of Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies, Seattle, WA.
4. Paine, E., Barucco, R., **Chang, Y.**, Navalta, T., Ehrhardt, A., & Bockting, W. (2022, April). *“Too Much Trouble”: Transgender and Nonbinary People’s Experiences of Stigma, Discrimination, and Affirmation in the Workplace*. Paper presented at 2022 Population Association of Americas annual conference. Atlanta, GA.
5. Calati, R., Maisto, M., Miranda, R., Thompson, L., Lesanpezeshki, M., Baiden, P., Miller, C., **Chang, Y.**, Wang, P., Grzenda, A., Kirchner, S., & Clarke, D. E. (2021, October) Ethnic discrimination and suicidal thoughts and behaviors: an international-intercontinental collaborative project for a systematic review. In G. Zalsman (Chair), *IASR Metanalysis and Systematic Review Workshop Project*. Paper presented at the 2021 IASR/AFSP International Summit on Suicide Research (held virtually).

Poster Presentations

1. **Chang, Y.**, Brown, V., Whitman, K., Dombrovski, A., & Szanto, K. (2022, April). Hippocampal MRI Volume Differences in Late-Life Suicidal Behavior. Poster presented at the IASR/AFSP International Summit on Suicide Research. Poster presented at the Society of Biological Psychiatry (SOBP) 2022 Annual Meeting. [[Poster](#)]

2. Galfalvy, H., Szűcs, A., Buerke, M., **Chang, Y.**, & Szanto, K. (2022, April). Long-term suicidal ideation profiles in late-life depression and their association with prospective suicide attempt and death by suicide. Poster presented at the Society of Biological Psychiatry (SOBP) 2022 Annual Meeting.
3. **Chang, Y.**, & Bockting, W. (2021, November). Identity Development Trajectories and Childhood Gender Role Nonconformity Among a Gender and Racial Diverse Sample in the United States. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (held virtually). [[Poster](#)]
4. **Chang, Y.**, Galfalvy, H., Buerke, M., & Szanto, K. (2021, October). Age of Onset of First Suicidal Behavior Determines Risk Factor Profiles in Older Suicide Attempters – Focus on Childhood Trauma Experiences. Poster presented at the IASR/AFSP International Summit on Suicide Research (held virtually). [[Poster](#)]
5. **Chang, Y.**, Brown, V., Whitman, K., Dombrowski, A., & Szanto, K. (2021, October). Hippocampal MRI Volume Differences in Late-Life Suicidal Behavior. Poster presented at the IASR/AFSP International Summit on Suicide Research (held virtually). [[Poster](#)]
 - Nominated as a poster finalist (Top 10) for the Early Career Researcher Best Poster Award
6. **Chang, Y.**, Galfalvy, H., Buerke, M., & Szanto, K. (2021, October). The Relationship of Childhood Trauma Experiences with the Age of Onset of First Suicidal Behavior in Late-Life Depression. Poster presented at the Pitt Psychiatry Research Day. Pittsburgh, PA. [[Poster](#)]
7. **Chang, Y.**, & Malgaroli, M. (2021, April). *Longitudinal Predictors of Non-Suicidal Self-Injury among Gender Diverse Population: Machine Learning Approaches*. 2021 Diversifying Clinical Psychology Conference, Council of University Directors of Clinical Psychology (held virtually).
8. **Chang, Y.**, & Chen, S. (2020, November). Identifying School-Based Intervention Targets for the Risk of Suicide Attempt Amongst Gender Questioning Youth. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (held virtually). [[Poster](#)]
9. Tang, S., & **Chang, Y.** (2020, August). Mental health disparities among LGBTQ Asian and Pacific islander youth: A cross sectional analysis (held virtually). Poster presented at the American Psychological Association Convention.
10. **Chang, Y.**, & Bockting, W. (2020, June). Childhood gender nonconformity and identity development among a diverse transgender community sample in the United States. Poster presented at the annual Journal of Clinical Child and Adolescent Psychology (JCCAP) Future Directions Forum (held virtually). [[Poster](#)]

NON-PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATION

1. **Chang, Y.** (2022, June). Three-Year Anniversary of Legalizing Same-Sex Marriage in Taiwan – Has Structural Stigma Decreased and Mental Health Improved? *Taiwan Women ePress*, 174(2). [In Mandarin] [[Article](#)]

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

1. **Chang, Y.** (2022, April) *Career Talk: Finding and Interviewing for Post-Bacc Positions as an International Student*. Invited talk presented at NextGen Psych Scholars Program (held virtually).
2. **Chang, Y.**, Schumacher, E., & Brian Thoma (2022, April) *The Relationship Between Structural Stigma and Suicidal Thoughts and Behaviors among SGM Youth*. Invited talk presented at the Enrichment Meeting at Longitudinal Research Program in Late-Life Suicide at UPMC Psychiatry, Pittsburgh, PA.
3. **Chang, Y.** (2021, August) *The Relationship of Childhood Trauma Experiences with the Age of Onset of First Suicidal Behavior in Late-Life Depression*. Invited talk presented at the Enrichment Meeting at Longitudinal Research Program in Late-Life Suicide at UPMC Psychiatry, Pittsburgh, PA. [[Slide](#)]

4. Brown, V. & **Chang, Y.** (2021, April) *Morphometric Alterations in Late-Life Suicide and Relationships with Cognitive Decline*. Invited talk presented at the Enrichment Meeting at Longitudinal Research Program in Late-Life Suicide at UPMC Psychiatry, Pittsburgh, PA. [[Slide](#)]
5. **Chang, Y.** (2021, April) *Career Talk: How to create a position for yourself during pandemic (as an international student)*. Invited talk presented at the Teachers College, Columbia University, New York, NY. [[Slide](#)]

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCES

2017 – 2018 **Taiwan LGBT Hotline Association**
Supervisor: Chia-Wei Shiu, MSW

Crisis Counselor

- Answered to 350+ callers and committed 15+ hours a week, including writing clinical reports and attending weekly clinical supervision
- Passed a selective screening process after completing an intensive 16-week clinical training on people centered counseling techniques, crisis management, and interventions

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

2021 **R Workshop**
 Designed materials and developed a workshop to teach R programming for beginners. The workshop included four sessions, including introduction to R, data wrangling, tidying data, data visualization, and data analysis. Please find my slides and R scripts on my [GitHub](#).

AWARDS & HONORS

2024 **Dartmouth QBS Merit Award (\$3,000)**
 2023 **Queer in STEM Scholarship (\$525)**
 2022 **Data Science Fellowship**, Correlation One
 2021 **Queer in STEM Scholarship (\$1,250)**
 2021 **Poster Finalist (Top 10)**, IASR/AFSP International Summit on Suicide Research
 2019 **Program Ambassador**, Dept. of Counseling and Clinical Psychology, TC, Columbia University
 2019 **Graduate Representative Speaker**, Admitted Student Day Student Panel, TC, Columbia University
 2019 **Psi Chi Psychology Honors Society**, TC, Columbia University
 2018 **Teachers College Scholarship (\$2,500, Merit-based)**, TC, Columbia University

REVIEWING EXPERIENCE

Ad-hoc Reviewing

BMC Digital Health, Paediatrics, Stigma and Health, American Journal of Public Health, Culture, Health & Sexuality

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2022 – 2024 International Society for Research on Internet Interventions (ISRII)
 2019 – 2024 Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies; Sexual and Gender Minority Interest Group
 2018 – 2020 American Psychological Association of Graduate Students; APA Division 44